

May

31

2016

Viral video

Catchy K-Pop hit *Gangnam Style* by South Korean rapper Psy became the first video to get 2 billion views on YouTube and was the site's most-watched video for nearly five years. Psy's routine sparked a global dance craze.

1740



Frederick the Great

Frederick II took over the throne of Prussia, a European kingdom that included northern Germany and Poland. He won many battles and turned Prussia into a powerful nation.

Also on this day

1879 The first electric railway, built by German engineer Werner von Siemens, was shown at the Berlin Trade Exhibition in Germany.

1910 Four provinces joined to form the Union of South Africa under a single government.

1970 The Huascarán debris avalanche, set off by the Ancash earthquake, devastated Yungay, Peru. It was the worst avalanche in history.

1895 Breakfast cereal

A patent for "flaked cereal" was filed by US doctor John Harvey Kellogg. While researching healthy foods for his patients, he had flaked a dough mixture, which he then served with milk – cornflakes.

Born this day

1921 Chien-Shiung Wu, Chinese-American scientist. She researched nuclear weapons for the Manhattan Project.

1930 Clint Eastwood, US actor and director. The star of the *Dirty Harry* film series, he has had a 60-year-long career.

1279 BCE

Powerful pharaoh

Ramesses II became pharaoh of the New Kingdom of ancient Egypt, beginning a 66-year-long reign in which he expanded the empire and built impressive monuments.

